COURSE SLIDES · WSQ

Mastering The Art of Conflict Resolution to Foster Team Collaboration and Success



WSQ Course Code: TGS-2023021752

Conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd · UEN 201200696W

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

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SSG DIGITAL ATTENDANCE

Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1. It is mandatory to take the AM, PM and Assessment digital attendance for WSQ-funded courses.
2. The trainer/administrator displays the digital attendance QR code from the SSG portal.
3. Scan the QR code with your mobile phone camera and submit your attendance.
4. A minimum of 75% attendance is required to be eligible for assessment and funding.

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GENERAL TRAINER PROFILE

About the Trainer



WSQ Trainer

Facilitator profile standards for this conflict-resolution programme.

ROLE

Approved adult educator and workplace-learning facilitator.

CREDENTIALS

Relevant ACTA/ACLP or equivalent adult-education credentials and domain experience.

FACILITATION

Able to manage sensitive dialogue, role-play safety, debriefing and policy boundaries.

LEARNER SUPPORT

Uses the approved academy support channel and protects participant confidentiality.

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YOUR TRAINER

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer
Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

ROLE
Principal Trainer, Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

CERTIFICATION / CREDENTIALS
20+ years of training and industry experience.

DELIVERS
WSQ programmes in leadership, workplace communication, digital transformation and professional capability.

FOUNDER
Founder and lead instructor at Tertiary Infotech / Tertiary Courses.

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ICE-BREAKER

Let's Know Each Other

1. Your name and organisation / role.

2. One kind of workplace disagreement you are comfortable discussing in general terms—without naming real people.

3. One conflict-handling skill you want to strengthen during this course.

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HOUSEKEEPING

Ground Rules

1. Set your mobile phone to silent mode.
2. Actively participate — no question is too small.
3. Respect each other's views: agree to disagree.
4. One conversation at a time.
5. Be punctual; return from breaks on time.
6. 75% attendance is required for funding eligibility.

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COURSE ACCREDITATION

Skills Framework

1

TSC Title

Conflict Management

2

TSC Code

RET-PMD-4001-1.1

3

Proficiency Level

Skills Framework

4

Structure

Four topics, eight workplace activities and two assessment instruments.

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4 TOPICS

Course Outline

1

Topic 1 — Identifying Conflicts

Signals · Stages · Facts and perceptions · Conflict history · Root causes · Impact

2

Topic 2 — Conflict Resolution Strategies

Emotional regulation · Conflict styles · Active listening · Sensitive dialogue · Negotiation · Mediation

3

Topic 3 — Managing Team Conflicts in the Workplace

Leader accountability · Team norms · Policy · Fair process · Coaching · Productive disagreement

4

Topic 4 — Reviewing Effectiveness and Preventing Recurrence

Outcome measures · Follow-up · Recurrence controls · Learning reviews · Legal and ethical safeguards

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SCHEDULE

Lesson Plan — 2 Days

Day 1

- Day 1 — Identify conflict and practise sensitive resolution, negotiation and mediation
  - Topic 1: identify signals, impact and root causes (Activities 1–2)
  - Topic 2: styles, dialogue, mediation and negotiation (Activities 3–5)

Day 2 & Assessment

- Day 2 — Lead team conflict, apply policy safeguards, review outcomes and prevent recurrence
  - Topic 3: leader responsibility and coaching (Activity 6)
  - Topic 4: policy, review and prevention (Activities 7–8)
  - Assessment: WA-SAQ (1h) + Case Study (1h), 4:00–6:00pm
- Daily timing
  - Day 1 and Day 2: 9:00am–6:00pm, including scheduled breaks and lunch.

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WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

Learning Outcomes

1

Identify Early

Recognise indicators, assess impact and minimise escalation.

2

Resolve Sensitively

Select and apply suitable strategies with fair communication.

3

Lead and Coach

Analyse team conflict and coach constructive disagreement.

4

Review and Prevent

Measure effectiveness and act on recurrence risks.

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Briefing for Assessment

1. Place phones and other materials under the table or on the floor.
2. No photos or recording of assessment scripts.
3. No discussion during the assessment.
4. Use a black/blue pen for hard-copy assessments.
5. No liquid paper / correction tape.
6. Scripts are collected when time is up.

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FINAL ASSESSMENT

Assessment

1. Written Assessment (WA-SAQ) — six open-ended questions, 1 hour, open book.
2. Case Study (CS) — one workplace scenario with four mapped questions, 1 hour, open book.
3. Format: Open Book — slides, Learner Guide and approved materials only.
4. A minimum of 75% attendance is required. Learners must complete both instruments and be assessed as Competent.
5. An appeal process is available if required.

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ON ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow

1. TRAQOM digital attendance — scan the QR code on the LMS
2. Assessment digital attendance — scan the SSG QR
3. Sit the WA-SAQ then the Case Study — open book
4. Submit your answers on the LMS
5. Sign the Assessment Summary Record

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COURSE PORTAL

Courseware & Assessment on the LMS

Everything for the open-book assessment — slides, Learner Guide and submissions — lives on the LMS.

Tertiary Infotech Academy

LMS and TMS for SSG courses

Sign in / OTP

lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com

1 **Sign in**
Log in with your registered email (OTP or password).

2 **Download materials**
Slides and the Learner Guide from the course page — your open-book references.

3 **Submit answers**
Upload your Written Assessment and Case Study answers on the LMS.

4 **TRAQOM attendance**
Complete TRAQOM digital attendance via the QR code shown on the LMS.

https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/

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LEARNER RESOURCES

Activity Files

Each activity has its own scenario, role cards, detailed instructions, worksheet, checklist and printable PDF set.

Open online

Use the GitHub course repository to browse or download the public activity folders.

Choose your activity

Open Activity-01 to Activity-08; every folder is self-contained.

Work from the guide

Detailed procedures stay in the Learner Guide and activity instructions—not in this deck.

Submit evidence

Use the approved LMS channel and avoid including real personal or confidential case data.

Open the Activities repository

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Topic 1

Topic 1

Identifying Conflicts

Signals · Stages · Facts and perceptions · Conflict history · Root causes · Impact

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Key Concepts — Identifying Conflicts

1. Conflict is more than disagreement: it arises when one or more parties perceive that important needs, interests, values, roles or resources are threatened.

2. Early indicators include changed communication, avoidance, cliques, repeated rework, defensive behaviour, absenteeism, complaints and declining service or output.

3. The escalation path moves from latent conditions to perceived tension, felt emotion, manifest behaviour and an aftermath that can repair or reinforce the pattern.

4. A fair assessment triangulates accounts, records, observations and context; it distinguishes facts from interpretations and tests alternative explanations.

5. Root causes often combine task, process, relationship, status, identity, resource, value and structural factors rather than one difficult personality.

6. Immediate safety, harassment, discrimination, retaliation or serious misconduct concerns require policy-led escalation rather than informal facilitation alone.

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TOPIC 1 · EARLY INDICATORS

Conflict is data before it becomes damage

A manager's first task is accurate recognition—not a fast verdict.

Communication

Silence, repeated interruption, sarcasm, side conversations or messages that bypass normal channels.

Coordination

Missed handoffs, duplicated work, withheld information or unexplained decision reversals.

People

Withdrawal, visible tension, repeated absence, complaints or requests to move team.

Results

Quality defects, delay, rework, customer complaints, safety exposure or lost opportunities.

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From latent tension to observable conflict

Intervene at the earliest stage that evidence and safety allow.

1 — Latent

Conditions exist: scarce resources, unclear roles or incompatible goals.

2 — Perceived

A party recognises an incompatibility or threat.

3 — Felt

Stress, anger, fear or frustration becomes personally experienced.

4 — Manifest

Conflict appears in words, behaviour, decisions or work results.

5 — Aftermath

Resolution, suppression or recurrence reshapes the next interaction.

Stages are a diagnostic lens, not a rigid or universal sequence.

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TOPIC 1 · EVIDENCE DISCIPLINE

Facts, claims, interpretations and unknowns

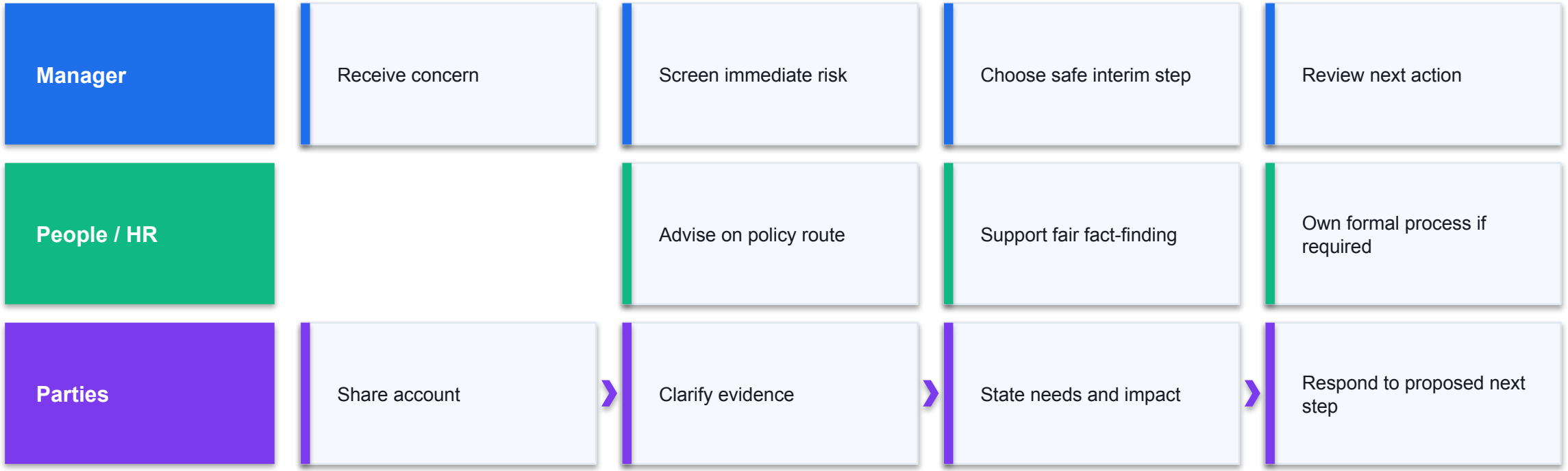
Neutral handling depends on preserving the status of information.

	Weak diagnostic language	Evidence-ready language
Label	‘She is hostile.’	‘She interrupted three times and raised her voice in Tuesday's meeting.’
Consensus	‘Everyone agrees.’	‘Two named colleagues reported similar concerns; five others were not interviewed.’
Cause	‘He caused the delay.’	‘The approval record is missing; two accounts disagree about the sequence.’
Root	‘It is only a personality clash.’	‘The handoff, incentive and decision-right conditions have not yet been tested.’

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A fair conflict-assessment workflow

Protection and evidence move in parallel; neither waits for certainty.



Sources: MOM workplace grievances and Tripartite Advisory; UC Berkeley Ombuds

Use a formal route when safety, harassment, discrimination, retaliation or serious misconduct is alleged.

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DIAGNOSTIC MINDSET

Observe the pattern.

Name what is known, what is reported and what still needs to be checked.

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T1

LO1 · Topic 1 · T1

a conflict signal triage

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What is a conflict signal triage?

1

Observable signal

What changed in words, behaviour, attendance, quality or customer impact?

2

Interpretation

What meaning are people assigning to the signal—and what else could explain it?

3

Immediate risk

Is there a safety, harassment, discrimination, retaliation or serious misconduct concern?

4

First response

Monitor, clarify, facilitate, escalate or activate a formal process.

Sources: HelpGuide; mindbodygreen; MOM workplace grievances

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Signal-to-Response Triage

1. **Observe**
   Record specific changes without labels or blame.
2. **Check impact**
   Test effects on people, work, customers and risk.
3. **Seek context**
   Gather more than one perspective and relevant records.
4. **Screen safety**
   Stop informal handling when policy or urgent protection is required.
5. **Choose next step**
   Name the owner, timing and evidence needed.

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Observation vs Assumption

Assumption

- Aisha is disengaged.
- Ben is sabotaging the rota.
- The team is toxic.
- Everyone hates the new process.

Evidence-ready observation

- Aisha spoke once in three meetings and cancelled two check-ins.
- Two rota changes were made without the agreed approval note.
- Four handoffs were returned and two staff requested transfers.
- Five of eight staff raised the same unclear-priority concern.

Sources: Atlassian objectivity guidance; UC Berkeley Ombuds

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Triage Decision Matrix

1

Low impact · low urgency

Monitor, clarify and set a check-in.

2

High impact · low urgency

Plan a structured conversation and evidence review.

3

Low impact · high urgency

Stabilise the immediate work issue, then review.

4

High impact · high urgency

Protect people, preserve evidence and escalate under policy.

Source: illustrative worked example

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The complaints appeared before the argument

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

LionCity Retail

A supervisor notices repeated shift swaps, silence in huddles, customer handoff errors and a private allegation of unfair weekend rostering. The correct first move is structured triage—not deciding who is difficult.

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LO1 · Topic 1 · T1 · ACTIVITY 1

Conflict Signal Triage at LionCity Retail

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

LionCity Retail's Orchard service team is preparing for a major promotion. Over three weeks, two experienced staff have repeatedly swapped shifts, huddles have become quiet, and four customer handoffs were returned for missing information.

Aisha privately tells supervisor Marcus that weekend duties are being allocated unfairly. Ben says Aisha is refusing to cooperate. Marcus has only fragments of chat messages and no agreed roster-change record. The promotion starts in five days.

You'll produce: A completed signal log, conflict-stage map and first-response decision

Duration: 45 minutes

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LO1 · Topic 1 · T1 · ACTIVITY 1

Conflict Signal Triage at LionCity Retail

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1. Which details are observable facts, reported claims and interpretations?
2. What indicators suggest latent, perceived, felt or manifest conflict?
3. What immediate impact is visible for staff, customers and the promotion?
4. What would make informal clarification unsafe or inappropriate?

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Conflict Signal Triage at LionCity Retail

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did you avoid diagnosing personality from limited evidence?
- Did your first response name an owner, deadline and escalation boundary?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The triage separates facts from assumptions, screens safety/policy risk and selects a proportionate next action.

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T2

LO1 · Topic 1 · T2

an evidence-based conflict diagnosis

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What is an evidence-based conflict diagnosis?

1. **Position**
   What each person says should happen.

2. **Interest**
   The need, concern or value underneath the position.

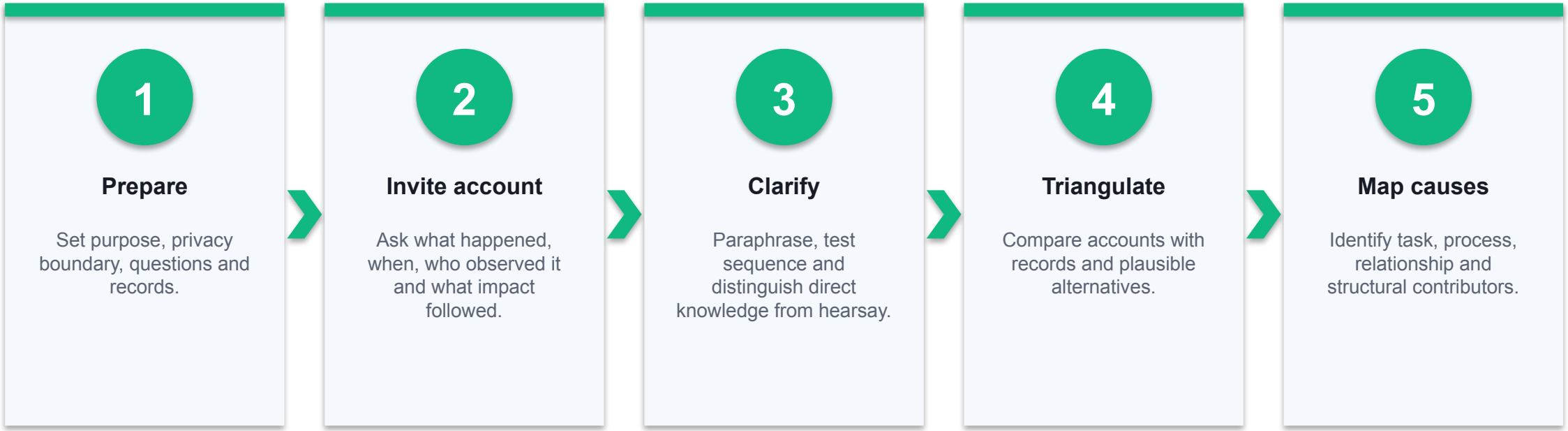
3. **Evidence**
   Records, observations and corroborated facts relevant to the issue.

4. **System factor**
   Role, handoff, incentive, workload or decision-right condition feeding the conflict.

Sources: Harvard PON; Study.com; Indeed workplace strategies

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Neutral Fact-Finding Interview



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Questioning That Opens vs Closes

Closing / accusatory

- Why did you ignore the procedure?
- Who started this?
- Don't you think Priya overreacted?
- Can you prove you are right?

Neutral / exploratory

- Walk me through the handoff from your perspective.
- What happened immediately before and after the missed scan?
- What impact did you observe, and what evidence supports it?
- What need or constraint would a workable solution have to address?

Sources: UC Berkeley Ombuds; active-listening guidance across supplied sources

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Root-Cause Lenses

1

Task

Different goals, quality standards or priorities.

2

Process

Unclear workflow, handoff, information or decision rights.

3

Relationship

Trust erosion, communication pattern or unresolved history.

4

Structure

Resource scarcity, incentives, workload, hierarchy or change.

Source: illustrative worked example

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Evidence Interview and Root-Cause Map at HarborLink Logistics

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

At HarborLink Logistics, warehouse lead Priya says transport planner Daniel repeatedly changes dispatch priorities without warning. Daniel says Priya's team ignores urgent customer requests and hides picking delays until late afternoon.

The shared dashboard records timestamps but not who approved priority changes. A new performance incentive rewards each function differently. Learners conduct two short interviews and build a root-cause map before recommending any resolution.

You'll produce: Interview notes, an evidence matrix and a multi-cause conflict map

Duration: 55 minutes

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LO1 · Topic 1 · T2 · ACTIVITY 2

Evidence Interview and Root-Cause Map at HarborLink Logistics

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1. Which questions reveal sequence, impact, evidence and underlying interests?
2. What information should be validated before deciding on blame or remedy?
3. Which root causes sit in the work system rather than either person's character?
4. What facts remain unknown, and how will you record that uncertainty?

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LO1 · Topic 1 · T2 · ACTIVITY 2

Evidence Interview and Root-Cause Map at HarborLink Logistics

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did each interviewee receive equal opportunity and comparable questions?
- Did the root-cause map include the conflicting incentives and missing approval trail?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The diagnosis shows a traceable evidence chain, at least two plausible causes and unanswered questions before strategy selection.

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Recap — Identifying Conflicts

1

Conflict Signal Triage at LionCity Retail

You can now: recognise early indicators, assess impact and decide the safe first response.

2

Evidence Interview and Root-Cause Map at HarborLink Logistics

You can now: gather and validate conflict information through neutral interviews and root-cause analysis.

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Topic 1 · WHY IT MATTERS

Treat early signals as data, not proof of blame.

Good assessment separates observable facts, interpretations, needs and risk.

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Topic 2

Topic 2

Conflict Resolution Strategies

Emotional regulation · Conflict styles · Active listening · Sensitive dialogue · Negotiation · Mediation

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Key Concepts — Conflict Resolution Strategies

1. The five common conflict styles—compete, collaborate, compromise, avoid and accommodate—are options with different levels of assertiveness and cooperation.

2. Emotional regulation comes before problem solving: notice triggers, lower arousal, check safety and agree when and where to talk.

3. Active listening uses open questions, paraphrasing, validation and summaries to surface needs without implying agreement with every claim.

4. Assertive communication describes observable behaviour and impact, names the need and makes a specific request without attacking character.

5. Interest-based negotiation separates people from the problem, explores underlying interests, generates options and checks agreements against objective criteria.

6. Use a neutral third party when direct dialogue is unsafe, stuck, affected by power imbalance or required by policy; choose facilitation, mediation, conciliation or formal investigation deliberately.

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TOPIC 2 · STYLE FIT

Select a response—do not default to a favourite style

Score the situation before choosing compete, collaborate, compromise, avoid or accommodate.

SAFE?

Urgent protection or non-negotiable standard?

STAKES

How important is the substantive result?

TRUST

How important is future working trust?

VOICE

Can both parties speak freely and fairly?

TIME

Temporary response before deeper resolution?

Sources: HelpGuide, Indeed and Syracuse University conflict-style guidance

One conflict may require different styles at different stages.

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CLEAR: a structure for sensitive conversation

Regulate first; then create a fair path from accounts to commitments.

1 — Cool & check

Readiness, safety, scope and power.

2 — Listen

Equal voice, paraphrase, emotion acknowledgement.

3 — Explore

Impact, interests, needs and shared goals.

4 — Agree

Generate and reality-test options.

5 — Record & review

Owners, behaviours, dates and follow-up.

Validation acknowledges experience; it does not decide that every claim is factually correct.

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The mediator owns the process—not the outcome

Neutrality is demonstrated through comparable opportunity, questions and scrutiny.

Safety

Check suitability, voluntariness, retaliation risk and formal-process boundaries.

Voice

Give comparable uninterrupted time and an opportunity to clarify or respond.

Reframing

Convert blame into observable behaviour, impact, interests and requests.

Agreement

Record commitments that are specific, lawful, owned, supported and reviewable.

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Position bargaining vs interest-based negotiation

Move from one demanded answer to several evidence-tested packages.

	Position bargaining	Interest-based negotiation
Focus	Argues for a fixed demand	Explores the needs and constraints beneath the demand
Value	Treats concessions as loss	Trades across differences and creates packages
Basis	Relies on power or persistence	Uses objective criteria, evidence and authority
Finish	Stops at verbal compromise	Records action, owner, timing, review and no-agreement route

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SENSITIVE HANDLING

Regulation precedes resolution.

A good technique fails when timing, safety or power makes the conversation unfair.

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T1

LO2 · Topic 2 · T1

a fit-for-purpose conflict style decision

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What is a fit-for-purpose conflict style decision?

1

Compete

High assertiveness, low cooperation; useful for urgent safety or non-negotiable standards.

2

Collaborate

High assertiveness and cooperation; useful for important, interdependent issues.

3

Compromise

Moderate exchange; useful when time matters and both can trade.

4

Avoid / accommodate

Useful for cooling off, low stakes or learning—but risky when overused.

Sources: HelpGuide; Indeed; Coursera conflict management; Syracuse University

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Choose a Style Deliberately

1

Safety

Is harm, policy breach or urgent action involved?

2

Importance

How important is the substantive outcome?

3

Relationship

How important is trust and future interdependence?

4

Power and voice

Can both parties participate freely and fairly?

5

Time

Is a temporary response needed before deeper resolution?

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Helpful Use vs Costly Overuse

Helpful use

- Compete to stop an unsafe act.
- Avoid briefly to cool down and prepare.
- Accommodate a low-value preference.
- Compromise on a temporary schedule.

Costly overuse

- Compete to protect ego or silence dissent.
- Avoid a recurring fairness problem.
- Accommodate until resentment grows.
- Compromise on ethics or safety standards.

Sources: HelpGuide Thomas-Kilmann overview; Indeed strategy guidance

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Style Selection Cases

1

Safety breach

Compete/decide now; investigate and learn later.

2

Shared product risk

Collaborate around evidence and common goals.

3

Temporary rota gap

Compromise with a review date.

4

Heated but non-urgent

Pause/avoid briefly, then re-engage.

Source: illustrative worked example

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LO2 · Topic 2 · T1 · ACTIVITY 3

Conflict Style Choice Clinic at BrightWorks Digital

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

BrightWorks Digital's product and sales teams disagree about releasing a feature before security testing is complete. Sales promises a launch date to a key client; Product says the unresolved issue may expose customer data.

The CEO wants a decision today, but both teams must work together for the next six months. Learners assess five possible styles and explain a staged response rather than declaring one style universally best.

You'll produce: A conflict-style decision matrix with a staged response rationale

Duration: 45 minutes

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LO2 · Topic 2 · T1 · ACTIVITY 3

Conflict Style Choice Clinic at BrightWorks Digital

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1. Which part of the issue is non-negotiable, and who has authority to decide it?
2. Where would collaboration add value after the immediate decision?
3. What power imbalance or voice risk must the facilitator manage?
4. What temporary agreement could protect the client relationship without compromising security?

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LO2 · Topic 2 · T1 · ACTIVITY 3

Conflict Style Choice Clinic at BrightWorks Digital

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did you distinguish a short-term emergency response from long-term resolution?
- Did you name the risks of overusing your preferred style?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The recommendation links each style choice to evidence about safety, stakes, relationship, power and time.

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T2

LO2 · Topic 2 · T2

a structured mediation conversation

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What is a structured mediation conversation?

1

Neutral process

The mediator manages fairness and dialogue, not a preferred outcome.

2

Validation

Recognise a person's experience without deciding that every claim is correct.

3

Reframing

Translate blame and fixed positions into interests, impact and requests.

4

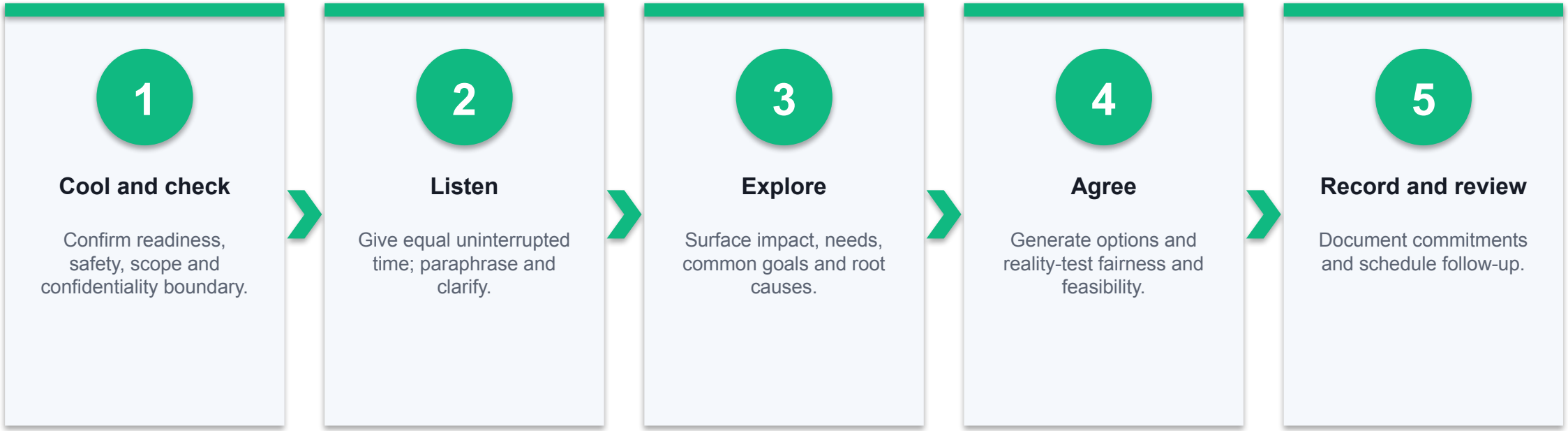
Agreement

Record specific behaviours, owners, timing, support and review.

Sources: UC Berkeley Ombuds; Training Industry; Study.com

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CLEAR Mediation Cycle



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Blame Language vs Reframing

Escalating statement

- Taylor shoots down everything I say.
- Alex cannot take feedback.
- This always happens.
- I want an apology before we continue.

Mediator reframe

- You need space to finish ideas before critique begins.
- You need feedback to be considered without defensiveness.
- Let's identify the specific recent pattern and impact.
- What acknowledgement and future behaviour would support repair?

Sources: supplied active-listening, validation and non-defensive communication guidance

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Mediator Quality Markers

1

Equal voice

Comparable time, questions and opportunity to respond.

2

Specificity

Behaviour, context and impact replace character labels.

3

Voluntary options

Parties generate and test choices within policy limits.

4

Durable follow-up

Commitments are observable, owned and reviewed.

Source: illustrative worked example

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Critique became personal before anyone named the process

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Mosaic Creative

Designer Alex needs uninterrupted time to present concepts; reviewer Taylor needs earlier risk testing. The mediator reframes the clash into a new critique protocol with time-boxes and a follow-up review.

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Mediated Conversation at Mosaic Creative

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

At Mosaic Creative, designer Alex says reviewer Taylor undermines ideas in client-preparation meetings by interrupting with risks. Taylor says Alex dismisses feedback and presents concepts too late for proper review.

Their manager Jordan will mediate. The shared goal is to improve client work without silencing critique. The issue is appropriate for mediation: there is no current allegation of harassment, discrimination or threat, and both parties agree to participate.

You'll produce: A recorded mediation role play, observer checklist and written resolution agreement

Duration: 60 minutes

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LO2 · Topic 2 · T2 · ACTIVITY 4

Mediated Conversation at Mosaic Creative

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1. What opening establishes purpose, neutrality and limits of confidentiality?
2. How will Jordan validate each perspective without taking sides?
3. Which shared interests can move the dialogue beyond positions?
4. What specific agreement would change the next design review?

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LO2 · Topic 2 · T2 · ACTIVITY 4

Mediated Conversation at Mosaic Creative

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did the mediator speak less than the parties and use balanced summaries?
- Did the agreement contain behaviours, owner, date and follow-up evidence?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The role play completes the CLEAR cycle and produces a balanced, observable and reviewable agreement.

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T3

LO2 · Topic 2 · T3

an interest-based workplace negotiation

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What is an interest-based workplace negotiation?

1

Position

The stated demand: what a party says it wants.

2

Interest

The reason underneath: safety, fairness, recognition, time or control.

3

Option

A possible package that addresses more than one interest.

4

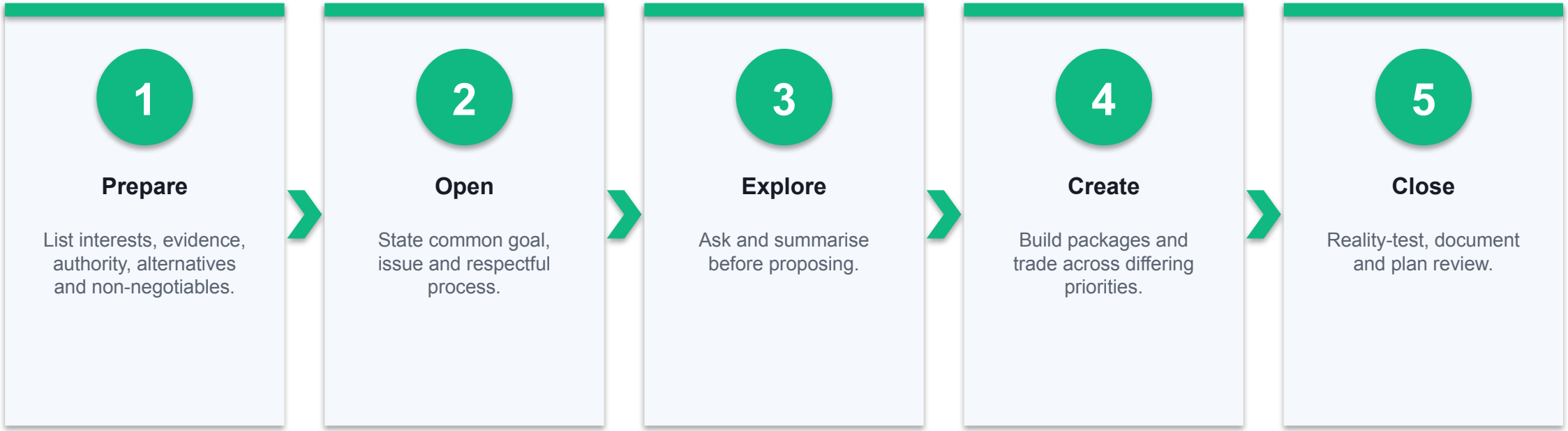
Criterion

An external standard, data point or policy used to evaluate fairness.

Sources: Harvard Program on Negotiation; Coursera; Indeed

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Interest-Based Negotiation



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Position Bargaining vs Interest-Based Dialogue

Position bargaining

- We need two more nurses—non-negotiable.
- Your team must cover weekends.
- Split everything 50/50.
- Agree now or I escalate.

Interest-based dialogue

- Which patient-safety and workload needs are driving the request?
- What coverage pattern protects both continuity and staff recovery?
- Which criteria make the distribution fair for different shift demands?
- What is within our authority, and what requires approval?

Source: interest-based negotiation synthesis from Harvard PON guidance

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Objective Criteria for the Clinic Rota

1. **Patient demand**
   Appointments, acuity and peak-time risk.

2. **Workload**
   Hours, complexity, recovery time and overtime.

3. **Capability**
   Required skills and safe coverage mix.

4. **Fairness**
   Rotation history, constraints and transparent exceptions.

Source: illustrative worked example

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LO2 · Topic 2 · T3 · ACTIVITY 5

Interest-Based Negotiation at CarePoint Clinics

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

CarePoint Clinics must cover three Saturday vaccination sessions during a seasonal surge. Nurse lead Mei wants two extra staff at each session; operations lead Arjun says the overtime ceiling permits only one.

Both need safe patient care and sustainable staffing. Each receives private interests and tradeable options, then negotiates a package using demand data, skill coverage, overtime limits and rotation history.

You'll produce: A negotiation preparation sheet, observed role play and signed implementation record

Duration: 60 minutes

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LO2 · Topic 2 · T3 · ACTIVITY 5

Interest-Based Negotiation at CarePoint Clinics

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1. What are each party's positions, interests, constraints and alternatives?
2. Which objective criteria should guide a fair rota?
3. What package trades across time, skill mix, session design and budget?
4. What must be recorded so implementation does not create a new conflict?

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LO2 · Topic 2 · T3 · ACTIVITY 5

Interest-Based Negotiation at CarePoint Clinics

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did the parties ask enough questions before exchanging proposals?
- Did the final package meet safety and authority boundaries?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The agreement explains interests, criteria, trade-offs, owners, escalation conditions and review date.

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Topic 2 RECAP

Recap — Conflict Resolution Strategies

1

Conflict Style Choice Clinic at BrightWorks Digital

You can now: select and justify a conflict style based on stakes, urgency, relationship and power.

2

Mediated Conversation at Mosaic Creative

You can now: conduct a sensitive mediated conversation using active listening, validation and option generation.

3

Interest-Based Negotiation at CarePoint Clinics

You can now: negotiate workload and service priorities using interests, options and objective criteria.

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Topic 2 · WHY IT MATTERS

The best strategy fits the stakes, urgency, relationship and power—not habit.

Pause, listen for interests, generate options, agree actions and record follow-up.

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Topic 3

Topic 3

Managing Team Conflicts in the Workplace

Leader accountability · Team norms · Policy · Fair process · Coaching · Productive disagreement

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Key Concepts — Managing Team Conflicts in the Workplace

1. Leaders set conditions for productive disagreement through clear roles, decision rights, behavioural norms, open channels and timely intervention.

2. Task conflict can improve decisions when psychological safety and shared goals are strong; relationship conflict and personal attacks usually erode collaboration.

3. A fair process gives each person notice, equal opportunity to speak, neutral fact-finding, confidentiality on a need-to-know basis and a documented outcome.

4. Organisational policies determine reporting, investigation, support, mediation, discipline, appeal, record-keeping and escalation responsibilities.

5. Conflict coaching helps team members notice patterns, reframe assumptions, choose a conversation strategy, practise language and commit to observable behaviour.

6. Managers must avoid retaliation, favoritism, forced reconciliation, premature promises of secrecy and informal handling of matters that require specialist or formal action.

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TOPIC 3 · LEADERSHIP

Leaders shape the conditions around conflict

A leader is accountable for both the conversation and the work system.

Model

Regulate emotion, use neutral language, invite dissent and avoid public blame.

Clarify

Set goals, roles, decision rights, handoffs and behavioural expectations.

Intervene

Respond early, protect voice and choose coaching, facilitation or formal escalation appropriately.

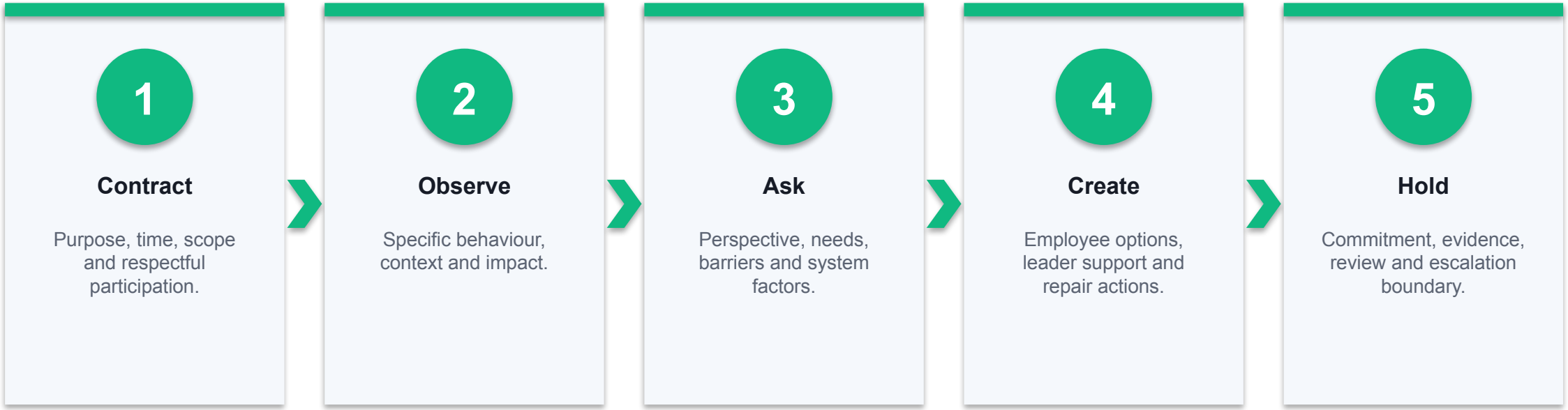
Learn

Review outcomes, remove structural causes and track recurrence risk.

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COACH: a fair accountability conversation

Specificity plus listening creates accountability without humiliation.

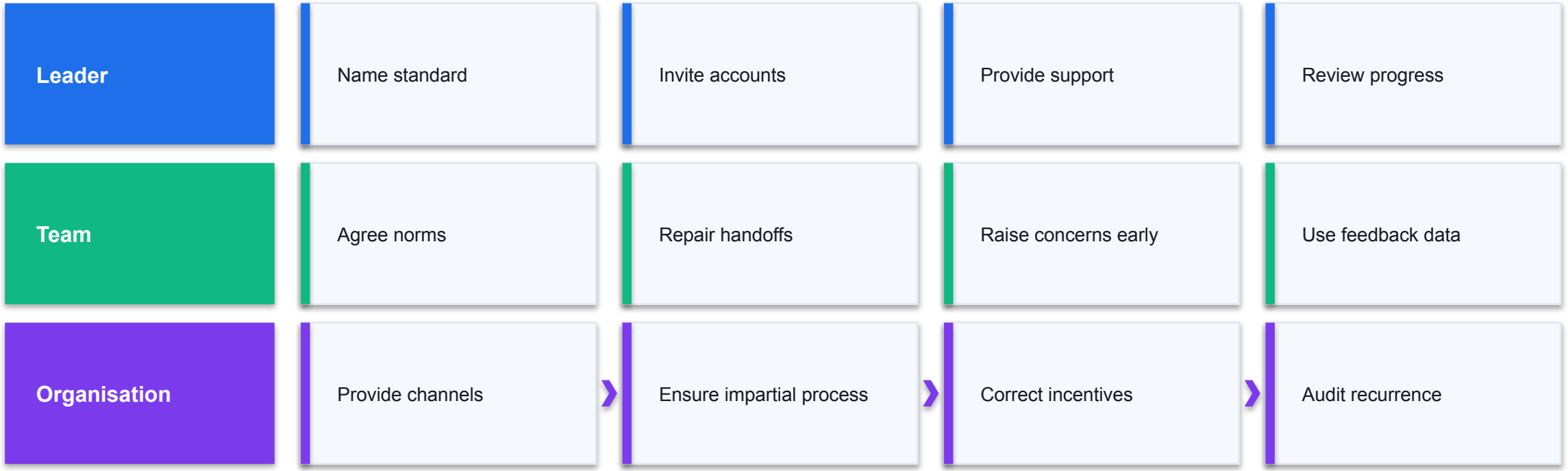


Coaching must not replace a required grievance, safety or formal performance process.

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Team conflict has more than one owner

Durable repair links individual behaviour, team norms and organisational systems.



Course synthesis from the supplied leadership and workplace sources

Psychological safety means people can raise work concerns without interpersonal punishment—not that every disagreement disappears.

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LEADERSHIP

Coach the person. Repair the system.

Accountability becomes durable when leaders change the conditions that keep producing the conflict.

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T1

LO3 · Topic 3 · T1

a conflict-coaching conversation

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What is a conflict-coaching conversation?

1

Coach, don't rescue

Build the team member's judgement rather than taking over the conflict.

2

Reframe

Test assumptions and translate labels into observable behaviour and impact.

3

Rehearse

Practise opening, listening, requests and responses to likely emotion.

4

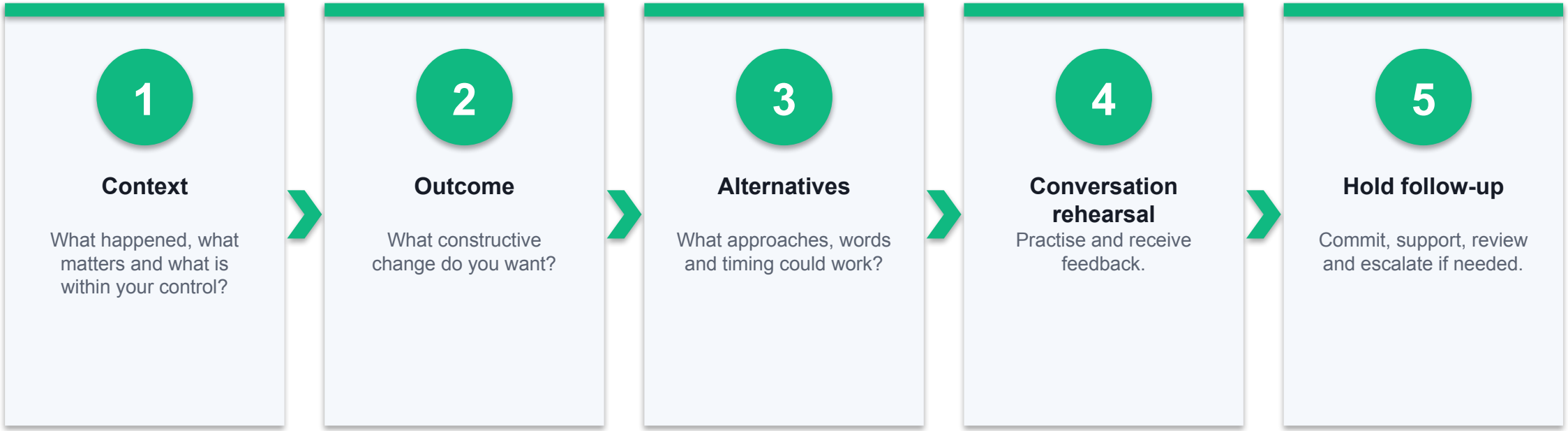
Support

Agree boundaries, resources, escalation triggers and follow-up.

Sources: Training Industry; SNHU; supplied leadership sources

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COACH Conversation



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Manager Rescue vs Capability Building

Rescue / direct

- I'll tell them to stop.
- You're right; they are the problem.
- Use this exact script.
- Come back only if it fails.

Coach / enable

- What outcome do you want and what evidence will you use?
- What might the other person see differently?
- Which opening sounds authentic and respectful to you?
- What support and review point will help you follow through?

Source: course coaching synthesis

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Coaching Boundaries

1

Coach

Skill gap, preparation, perspective and manageable interpersonal issue.

2

Facilitate

Parties want dialogue but need process support.

3

Escalate

Safety, harassment, discrimination, retaliation or authority limit.

4

Follow up

Behavioural commitment, work impact and recurrence indicators.

Source: illustrative worked example

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LO3 · Topic 3 · T1 · ACTIVITY 6

Leader Coaching Huddle at NovaTech Services

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

At NovaTech Services, project lead Jordan feels that analyst Alex dismisses project decisions in meetings. Alex says Jordan closes discussion too quickly and uses seniority to override technical concerns.

Department manager Taylor will coach Jordan first, not decide the dispute. Jordan must prepare a direct conversation that protects Alex's voice, clarifies decision rights and sets a follow-up checkpoint.

You'll produce: A completed COACH worksheet, rehearsal record and follow-up plan

Duration: 60 minutes

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LO3 · Topic 3 · T1 · ACTIVITY 6

Leader Coaching Huddle at NovaTech Services

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1. Which questions help Jordan separate facts, feelings, assumptions and needs?
2. What part of the conflict should Jordan own?
3. How can Jordan invite technical challenge without reopening every decision?
4. Which condition would require Taylor to move from coaching to formal action?

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LO3 · Topic 3 · T1 · ACTIVITY 6

Leader Coaching Huddle at NovaTech Services

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did the coach avoid endorsing Jordan's story as fact?
- Did Jordan leave with chosen language, support and a review point?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The coaching plan keeps ownership with Jordan while defining safe boundaries, rehearsal feedback and follow-up.

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Recap — Managing Team Conflicts in the Workplace

1

Leader Coaching Huddle at NovaTech Services

You can now: coach team members to prepare and own a constructive conflict conversation.

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Topic 3 · WHY IT MATTERS

A leader owns the process, not every person's preferred outcome.

Fairness means a clear process, equal voice, evidence, boundaries and follow-through.

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Topic 4

Topic 4

Reviewing Effectiveness and Preventing Recurrence

Outcome measures · Follow-up · Recurrence controls · Learning reviews · Legal and ethical safeguards

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Key Concepts — Reviewing Effectiveness and Preventing Recurrence

1. Review effectiveness against agreed outcomes, behavioural commitments, work performance, relationship quality, stakeholder impact and signs of recurrence.

2. A resolution can be accepted yet ineffective; use scheduled check-ins, observable indicators and confidential feedback to test whether change lasts.

3. Prevention actions may clarify roles, rebalance workload, redesign handoffs, strengthen meeting norms, train staff, improve reporting channels or revise policy.

4. Document only what is necessary, accurate, authorised and proportionate; restrict access and follow organisational retention and personal-data requirements.

5. Singapore guidance supports prompt grievance channels, open communication, fair treatment, trained neutral fact-finding and safeguards against retaliation.

6. Serious harassment, threats, discrimination, safety or criminal concerns must be escalated to the authorised function or external authority; this course is not legal advice.

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TOPIC 4 · REVIEW

A resolution is effective only if evidence changes

Do not confuse silence, avoidance or a signed agreement with durable resolution.

BEHAV

Are agreed behaviours occurring?

PROCESS

Are handoffs and decision rights clearer?

RESULT

Did delay, error or customer impact improve?

VOICE

Do affected people report fairness and safety?

RISK

Any retaliation, recurrence or displacement?

Course synthesis from supplied conflict-resolution and workplace-guidance sources

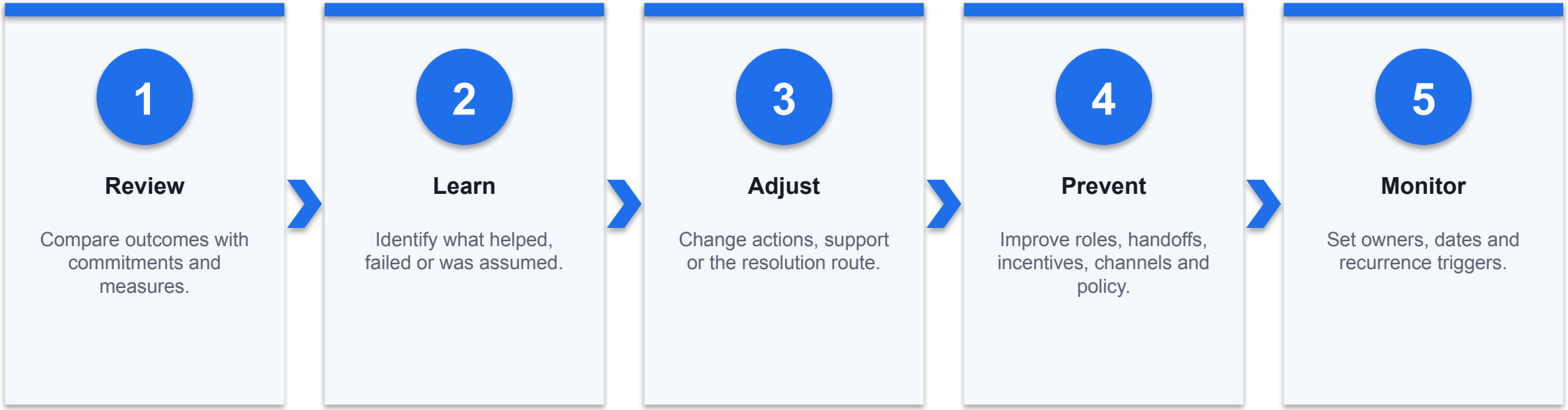
Use leading and lagging indicators; record baselines, targets, sources and owners.

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TOPIC 4 · IMPROVEMENT CYCLE

Review, learn, adjust, prevent

Follow-up closes the loop between an agreement and organisational learning.



A partially effective outcome is useful evidence—not a reason to declare success prematurely.

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Informal resolution vs formal process

Choose the route by safety, policy, power and alleged conduct—not convenience.

	Informal may fit	Formal route may be required
Voice	Parties can participate freely	Threat, coercion, retaliation or serious power imbalance
Conduct	Issue concerns workable behaviour or coordination	Harassment, discrimination, violence or serious misconduct allegation
Urgency	No urgent protection or evidence risk	Immediate protection or evidence preservation is needed
Authority	Agreement can remain within authority and policy	Finding, sanction, statutory duty or independent investigation is required

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Policy-aligned handling protects everyone

This course provides management guidance, not legal advice; use current policy and professional advice for real cases.

Access

Provide clear reporting channels and an alternative where the direct manager is involved.

Fairness

Use impartial fact-finding, an opportunity to respond and proportional interim measures.

Privacy

Limit personal data to a stated purpose, need-to-know access and secure handling.

Protection

Address safety, support needs and retaliation risk while the process is ongoing.

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REVIEW

Agreement is a hypothesis.

Follow-up evidence tells you whether the resolution worked and what must change next.

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T1

LO4 · Topic 4 · T1

a policy-led escalation decision

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What is a policy-led escalation decision?

1

Fair process

Notice, neutral inquiry, equal voice, evidence, reasoned outcome and appeal route.

2

Confidentiality

Share on a need-to-know basis; never promise secrecy that policy or safety cannot support.

3

Non-retaliation

Protect genuine reporters and participants from detrimental treatment.

4

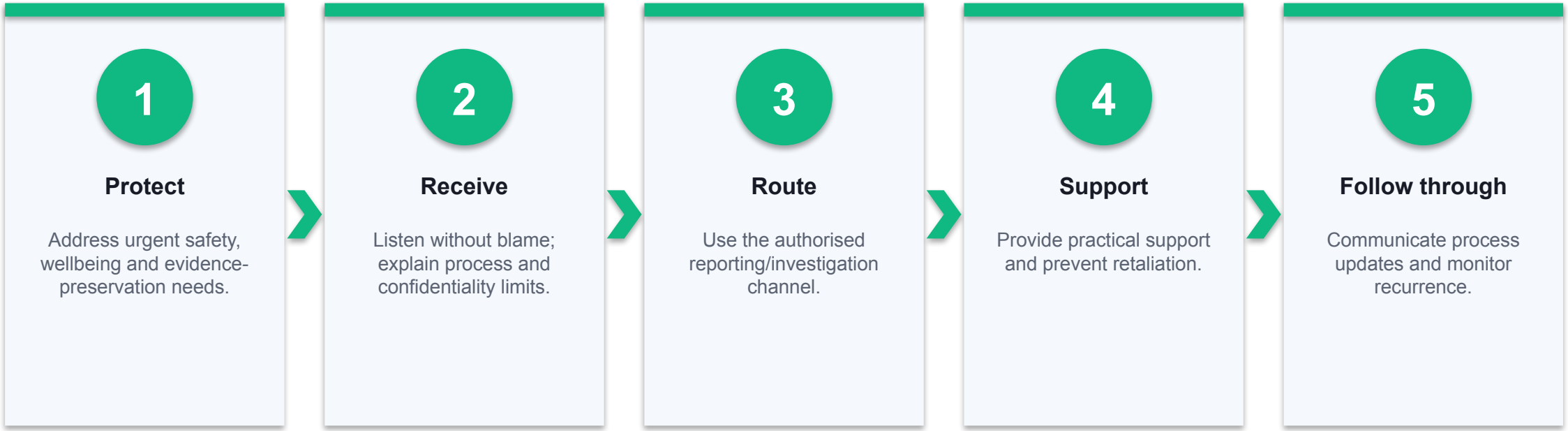
Proportionate action

Match support, interim controls, investigation and consequences to risk and evidence.

Sources: Singapore MOM/TAFEP harassment advisory; PDPC; Ministry of Law

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Policy-Led Response Gate



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LO4 · Topic 4 · T1 · COMPARE

Informal Resolution vs Formal Handling

Informal may fit

- Different work preferences with free participation.
- Specific low-risk misunderstanding.
- Both parties want a facilitated dialogue.
- No safety, harassment or retaliation concern is present.

Formal handling required / safer

- Threat, harm, harassment or discriminatory conduct.
- Retaliation, coercion or significant power imbalance.
- Repeated conduct after prior intervention.
- Policy, law or evidence-preservation duty requires investigation.

Sources: MOM workplace harassment advisory; MOM workplace grievances

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Ethical Case-Handling Controls

1

Need-to-know

Restrict case data and avoid gossip or unnecessary circulation.

2

Neutrality

Use trained, conflict-free decision makers and comparable questioning.

3

Accuracy

Record dates, sources, uncertainty, corrections and decisions.

4

Support

Offer safe channels, interim options and protection from retaliation.

Source: illustrative worked example

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LO4 · Topic 4 · T1 · ACTIVITY 7

Policy, Ethics and Escalation at Meridian Hospitality

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

At Meridian Hospitality, employee Farah reports that colleague Leon has repeatedly made jokes about her religion in a team chat. She fears that complaining will affect shift allocation because Leon is close to the duty manager.

A supervisor suggests putting both employees in a room to 'clear the air'. Learners must decide the immediate response, authorised channel, confidentiality boundary, interim support and documentation required under organisational policy. This activity is educational and not legal advice.

You'll produce: An escalation decision record, case-handling checklist and stakeholder communication plan

Duration: 55 minutes

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LO4 · Topic 4 · T1 · ACTIVITY 7

Policy, Ethics and Escalation at Meridian Hospitality

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1. Why is immediate informal mediation inappropriate as the default response?
2. What can Ravi promise—and what must he not promise—about confidentiality?
3. What records and personal data are necessary, accurate and restricted?
4. What interim support and anti-retaliation monitoring should be arranged?

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LO4 · Topic 4 · T1 · ACTIVITY 7

Policy, Ethics and Escalation at Meridian Hospitality

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did your response protect the reporter without prejudging the allegation?
- Did you distinguish organisational process from legal advice and external recourse?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The response activates the correct policy channel, protects safety and fairness, limits data access and defines non-retaliation follow-up.

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T2

LO4 · Topic 4 · T2

a measurable resolution review

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What is a measurable resolution review?

1. **Outcome**
   Was the agreement implemented and the original work impact reduced?

2. **Behaviour**
   Are observable commitments occurring consistently?

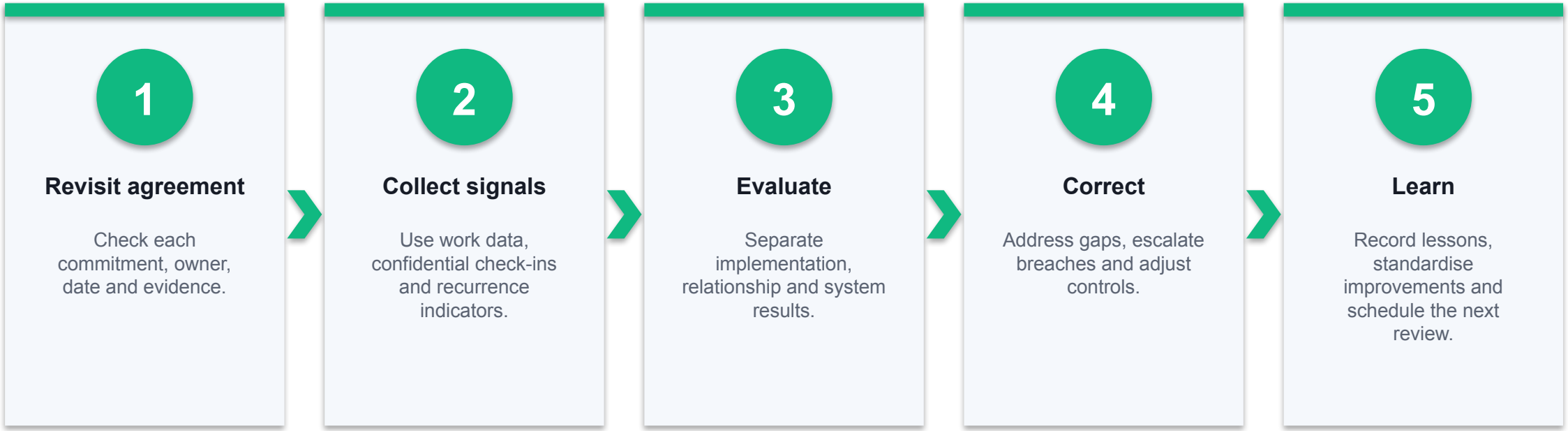
3. **Relationship**
   Can parties raise concerns and cooperate without avoidance or retaliation?

4. **System**
   Were role, workload, process or policy conditions corrected?

Sources: Atlassian; Indeed; Training Industry; MOM grievance guidance

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Review-and-Prevent Cycle



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Weak Follow-Up vs Effective Review

Weak follow-up

- Ask whether everyone is okay.
- Assume silence means success.
- Review only the two individuals.
- Close the file after an apology.

Effective review

- Check named behaviours and work outcomes against baseline.
- Use multiple indicators and safe private feedback.
- Review workload, handoffs, norms and manager action.
- Assign controls, owners, dates and escalation triggers.

Source: continuous-improvement synthesis

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Balanced Review Scorecard

1

Work

Rework, delay, service quality and handoff reliability.

2

People

Participation, stress signals, trust and psychological safety.

3

Agreement

Completion of actions and adherence to behavioural commitments.

4

Recurrence

Repeat triggers, complaints, workarounds and policy breaches.

Source: illustrative worked example

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The apology worked; the handoff still failed

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

GreenGrid Engineering

Two engineers report less interpersonal tension after mediation, but late design changes continue because decision rights remain unclear. The 30-day review separates relationship repair from unresolved process risk.

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LO4 · Topic 4 · T2 · ACTIVITY 8

30-Day Resolution Review at GreenGrid Engineering

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

GreenGrid Engineering mediated a conflict between design lead Noor and site lead Ethan after repeated late drawing changes caused rework. They agreed on respectful language, a 3:00pm change cut-off and a weekly coordination meeting.

Thirty days later, meeting tone has improved and both report less stress, but three changes still arrived after the cut-off. Two were safety-related; one resulted from unclear approval authority. Learners evaluate effectiveness and design recurrence controls.

You'll produce: A 30-day effectiveness scorecard, learning review and recurrence-prevention action plan

Duration: 55 minutes

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LO4 · Topic 4 · T2 · ACTIVITY 8

30-Day Resolution Review at GreenGrid Engineering

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1. Which parts of the original resolution were effective, partly effective or ineffective?
2. What evidence is needed beyond self-report?
3. Which recurrence cause is behavioural, and which is structural?
4. What preventive control, owner, date and trigger should be added?

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LO4 · Topic 4 · T2 · ACTIVITY 8

30-Day Resolution Review at GreenGrid Engineering

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did you avoid treating all exceptions as breaches?
- Does the prevention plan change the system as well as individual behaviour?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The review reaches an evidence-based verdict and adds preventive controls with ownership, timing and measurable follow-up.

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Topic 4 RECAP

Recap — Reviewing Effectiveness and Preventing Recurrence

1

Policy, Ethics and Escalation at Meridian Hospitality

You can now: distinguish resolvable disagreement from conduct requiring formal, confidential escalation.

2

30-Day Resolution Review at GreenGrid Engineering

You can now: evaluate resolution effectiveness and design controls that prevent recurrence.

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Topic 4 · WHY IT MATTERS

Closure is an agreement; prevention is a changed system.

Review both the relationship and the work, then remove the condition that fed the conflict.

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SOURCE-ALIGNED COURSEWARE

Sources & Further Reading — 1

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   atlassian.com

3. **Coursera: conflict resolution skills**
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5. **SNHU: conflict resolution in the workplace**
   snhu.edu

6. **Situational Leadership: leader conflict resolution skills**
   situational.com

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Sources & Further Reading — 2

1. **Worksafe UK: five essential conflict resolution skills**
   worksafe.uk.com

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5. **HelpGuide: conflict resolution skills**
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6. **Harvard Program on Negotiation: conflict resolution strategies**
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1. **Harvard Business School Online: workplace conflict resolution**
   online.hbs.edu

2. **Coursera: conflict management**
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3. **Syracuse University: conflict management strategies**
   ischool.syracuse.edu

4. **UC Berkeley Ombuds: tips, tools and techniques**
   studentaffairs.berkeley.edu

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SOURCE-ALIGNED COURSEWARE

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1. **Academy of Business Research: conflict resolution strategies**
   abacademies.org

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6. **Singapore PDPC: personal data protection obligations**
   pdpc.gov.sg

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COURSE WRAP-UP

The Resolve-and-Prevent Playbook

01

Recognise

Observe signals, assess impact and separate facts from assumptions before choosing a response.

02

Regulate

Check safety, manage triggers, select the right time and agree respectful ground rules.

03

Resolve

Listen for interests, choose a fit-for-purpose strategy, agree actions and document ownership.

04

Review

Measure the outcome, follow up, learn from recurrence indicators and improve the work system.

Recognise early, regulate emotion, resolve fairly, then review the system that allowed the conflict to grow.

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WRAP-UP

Course Summary & Next Steps

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LEARNING OUTCOMES

What You Achieved

1

Identify Early

Recognised indicators and separated evidence from assumptions.

2

Resolve Sensitively

Selected styles and practised listening, mediation and negotiation.

3

Lead and Coach

Used fair leadership and coaching to repair team dynamics.

4

Review and Prevent

Measured outcomes and addressed recurrence in the work system.

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WRAP-UP

Assessment

1

Written Assessment (WA-SAQ)

Six open-ended questions — 1 hour, open book.

2

Case Study (CS)

One scenario, four questions — 1 hour, open book.

3

Open Book

Slides, Learner Guide and approved materials only.

4

Submit

On the LMS — lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com

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ON ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow

1. TRAQOM digital attendance — scan the QR code on the LMS
2. Assessment digital attendance — scan the SSG QR
3. Sit the WA-SAQ then the Case Study — open book
4. Submit your answers on the LMS
5. Sign the Assessment Summary Record

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SSG DIGITAL ATTENDANCE

Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1. It is mandatory to take the AM, PM and Assessment digital attendance for WSQ-funded courses.
2. The trainer/administrator displays the digital attendance QR code from the SSG portal.
3. Scan the QR code with your mobile phone camera and submit your attendance.
4. A minimum of 75% attendance is required to be eligible for assessment and funding.

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SEE YOU AT THE NEXT ONE

Thank You!

You are now equipped to recognise conflict early, respond fairly and turn resolution into stronger team practice.

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